



Reddit's Profile redesign

Reddit has started offering users a new profile-page design that allows them to post directly to their profile. <http://dgit.in/ReReddit>

Outfit compare

Amazon Prime members will be able to shop better online with the upcoming Outfit Compare feature. <http://dgit.in/AmznCompr>

higher side, but the head-phone being fairly sensitive shouldn't be difficult to drive, even for a phone. In which case a microphone would've been a welcome addition. That being



Brainwavz B100

said, it's only a small niggle. If you are in the market for a great sounding pair of headphones, you can't go wrong with the Brainwavz B100.

PROS

- + Accurate, true to source.
- + Good for any genre
- + Affordable for a balanced armature IEM

CONS

- o No microphone
- o Doesn't look all that great

AUDIO-TECHNICA ATH-ANC33IS

The Audio-Technica ATH-ANC33iS is a unique IEM when compared to all the others featured in this test. It is one of the most affordable Active Noise Cancellation earbuds out there.

Build & Design: The design for the ANC33iS is very simple and functional. The ear piece looks typically like any of the other Audio-Technica in-ears we've seen before. The Active Noise Cancellation unit is in-line and hardly heavier than the single AAA battery that

it houses. It comes with a clip that can let you securely fasten it to you to say a pant pocket. The ANC33iS also comes with an in-line microphone and single button remote.

Features & Performance:

The ANC33iS is possibly the warmest sounding in-ear in the test. It lacks that crisp detail in the higher ranges but isn't all that bad. In the lower end of the spectrum there is adequate bass but the bass could've been punchier. It's present in the right amount but just not very tight or hard-hitting. The passive isolation on the ANC33iS is quite bad, but since it has active cancellation it doesn't matter all that much. The ANC doesn't apply any amping or DSP like I've seen a couple of other ANC units do. With or without – the sound signature remains the same.

Our newest addition to the test tracks repertoire *Shape of You* by Ed Sheeran sounded fairly decent but the vocals sounded a little recessed. Incidentally, in case you are curious, we tried testing the mic with and without the ANC on, but it made no difference to the audio quality. So the ambient cancellation is only for the audio drivers.

How good is the ANC you ask? It's fairly decent at blocking out constant low rumble noises like say the hum of the Air Conditioning. To a certain extent it can even subdue traffic noises, but if you expect total silence that not what ANC does anyway. To draw a comparison I had my trusty Bose QC 20 active noise cancellation in-ears with me. Of course the QC20 is much better at blocking out ambient noise. It would be unreasonable to expect

the 33iS to be as good as one fourth the cost. But is it 1/4th as good? I'd say it is.

Verdict: Would I recommend buying these if not for the ANC? Probably not. You'd certainly get better in-ears for the same price. But if you are looking for a pair of decent sounding in-ears and ANC is an *essential* feature for you, this is the headphone you must pick up.

PROS

- + Active noise cancellation works fairly well
- + Great for flights with airplane adapter bundled

CONS

- o A bit too warm
- o Detail and precision could've been better
- o No hardcase

A-JAYS FOUR+

Jays is a Swedish company known for making minimalist yet beautiful audio gear. I remember their over the ear u-Jays headphone and it too had the same attention given towards aesthetics. But is beauty skin deep? Not at all. I'd say the a-Jays Four+ is a misunderstood device. Because of the kind of hipster appeal it seems to have, most audiophiles might be inclined to dismiss it as one of those mindless upgrades over bundled in-ears. I found their sound quality to be much more than a simple upgrade. **Build & Design:** Let's start with the box. For such a huge carton, you get very little inside. There's no carry case (gasp!). We got the white variant, and I have to admit, they exude a certain understated classy appeal. The tangle free flat cable is absolutely tangle free. In fact, it's got the

highest score in the test in this department. The three button remote is specifically wired to be compatible with either iOS or Android depending on the version you opt for, so pick carefully when purchasing. In terms of build quality the a-Jays Four Plus seems tough. You could get away with just throwing them in your backpack without a case and be just fine.

Features & Performance:

There nothing much to speak of with respect to features – it's just a basic pair of in-ears. The performance bit *does* need elaboration. The presentation on the a-Jays Four+ is super aggressive. It's like this nice deep U shaped sound signature. Sure the sound loses out being full bodied but the a-Jays more than compensates for it by performing exceptionally in the two extremes that it produces well. Take for instance our EDM-esque track *Stereo Love*. It didn't sound as spacious as on the Brainwavz S3, but the thump was accurate and hard hitting. It'll get anyone moving and grooving. Live performances sounded hollow and lacking body. Our live sample - *Pink Floyd's Shine On* from the *Pulse Tour* sounded like a few microphones on stage got accidentally turned off. At the same tracks like Ed Sheeran's *Shape of You* sounded sharp and detailed; sparkly even (guess the mix was right for the a-Jays). The headphone had one of the better microphones in the test but cable microphonics was a problem **Verdict:** So yes in the end the a-Jays Four + do make for a worthy upgrade over your bundled but they are much more than just that. They are hardy, stylish and sound